

THE **AI** REPORT

The AI Decision Playbook

25 CLAUDE PROMPTS

for Better Business Decisions



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Trusted by 400,000+ business leaders

3 years covering AI for business leaders daily

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The Natural Next Step

INTRODUCTION

EXECUTIVES MAKE BETTER DECISIONS
WITH AI. **THE DATA ON THIS IS NOW CLEAR.**

60%
of executives



Deloitte's 2026 Global Human Capital Trends survey of more than 9,000 business leaders found that 60% of executives now regularly use AI to support their decision-making.

72%
of CEOs



BCG's AI Radar 2026, surveying 2,360 executives across 16 markets, found that 72% of CEOs now identify themselves as the primary decision-maker on AI in their organisations, double from the prior year.



But there's a gap between using AI and using it well.

Most professionals use AI for content. They draft documents, summarise reports, and generate ideas. The executives who are moving fastest are using it differently: as a structured thinking partner that pressure-tests their reasoning before they commit.



The difference is the prompt.

This guide gives you 25 of them, five for each of the five most important categories of business decisions. Each one is designed to improve the quality of your thinking, not replace it.

HAVE YOU UPGRADED YET?

**THE AI LEADERS LAUNCH GUIDE UNLOCKS
THE FULL IMPLEMENTATION SYSTEM**

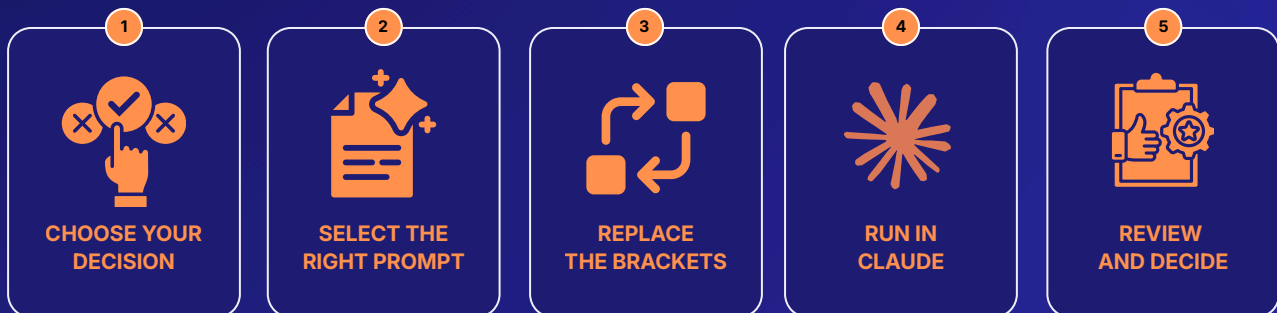
See what's inside: (\$9/month)

<https://www.theaireport.ai/leaders-launch-guide>

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Before a significant decision, run the prompt that matches your decision type. Replace the brackets with your specifics. Read the output with the same critical eye you'd bring to advice from a trusted colleague, not as a verdict, but as structured input.

The goal is better thinking before you commit. Not outsourcing the decision.



CATEGORY 1

STRATEGIC DECISIONS

Decisions with long time horizons, significant resource implications, and outcomes that are hard to reverse.

1. Pressure-Test a Strategy

"Act as a rigorous strategic critic. Here is my strategy or plan: [describe]. Identify every assumption embedded in it, stated and unstated. For each assumption, rate it on two dimensions: how confident we should be that it's true, and how much damage it would do to the strategy if it turned out to be wrong. Flag the two or three assumptions that pose the highest combined risk."

2. Evaluate a New Market Opportunity

"Evaluate this market opportunity: [describe]. Assess it across five dimensions: market size and growth trajectory, competitive intensity, our right to win given current capabilities, capital required to compete, and strategic fit with our current direction. Give me a go/no-go recommendation with the key condition that would change your view."

3. Decide Whether to Pivot or Stay the Course

"I need to decide whether to pivot or stay the course on [describe current direction]. Here is what the data is telling me: [share what you know]. Here is what I'm uncertain about: [describe]. Build two scenarios: one where the current signals are a real problem requiring a change, and one where they are noise that will resolve. Tell me what I would need to see in the next 60 days to know which scenario is true."

4. Assess an Acquisition or Partnership

"I'm considering [acquisition/partnership] with [describe the opportunity]. Evaluate it across: strategic fit with our current direction, capabilities we gain, risks we absorb, integration complexity, and what it signals to the market. Give me the three questions I need to have answered in due diligence before I can make this decision."

5. Prioritize Between Competing Initiatives

"Here are the strategic initiatives I'm choosing between: [list]. Prioritize them using these criteria: expected impact on revenue or competitive position, resource requirements, time to first results, and risk if we deprioritize. Give me a ranked order with the one condition that would cause you to reorder the top two."

CATEGORY 2

PROBLEM SOLVING

When something isn't working and you need to identify what's actually wrong before deciding how to fix it.

6. Root Cause Analysis

"Here is a problem I keep seeing: [describe]. Use a five-whys analysis to identify the most likely root cause. Then tell me: is this a structural problem, a skills problem, or a prioritization problem? And what is the one intervention that would have the highest impact if your diagnosis is correct?"

7. Generate Alternatives When You're Stuck

"I've been trying to solve [problem] by [current approach] and it's not working. Generate five genuinely different alternative approaches, specifically ones that challenge the assumption that [state your core assumption]. For each one, tell me what it requires that we don't currently have."

8. Identify the Real Bottleneck

"Here is the system or process I'm trying to improve: [describe]. Identify the single bottleneck that, if removed, would most improve throughput. Then tell me why this bottleneck is often the last one people look at."

9. Apply First Principles Thinking

"Everyone in [industry/domain] assumes that [describe a common assumption]. Apply first principles thinking: break this assumption down into its component parts and tell me which parts are actually constraints and which parts are just habits. What would you do differently if you were starting from scratch with no inherited assumptions?"

10. Diagnose Why Something Isn't Working

"Here is what I was expecting to happen: [describe]. Here is what actually happened: [describe]. Diagnose the most likely reasons for the gap, not the obvious ones, but the ones that are hardest to see from inside the situation. Tell me whether this looks like a planning failure, an execution failure, or an assumption failure."

CATEGORY 3

DECISION FRAMEWORKS

When you need structured thinking, not just analysis.

11. Build a Decision Matrix

"I need to decide between [list options] using these criteria: [list criteria]. Build a decision matrix that scores each option against each criterion on a scale of 1-5. Weight the criteria by importance to our current situation: [describe priorities]. Give me the result and tell me which criterion most influenced the outcome."

12. Run a Pre-Mortem

"I am about to commit to [decision or project]. Imagine it is 12 months from now and this has failed badly. Working backwards, what are the three most likely reasons it failed? For each one, what should I put in place now to reduce the probability?"

13. Apply Devil's Advocate

"My team has converged on the following decision: [describe]. Play devil's advocate as rigorously as possible. Make the strongest case against this decision, not a balanced view, the strongest possible critique. Don't soften it. Then tell me what evidence would be most likely to convince you the decision is actually right."

14. Analyze Second-Order Consequences

"If [decision], what happens next? Map the first-order consequences. Then, for the two most significant first-order consequences, map the second-order consequences, what happens as a result of those? Flag the second-order consequence I'm least likely to have considered."

15. Worst-Case Scenario Planning

"I am considering [decision]. Walk me through the worst-case scenario in detail, not the unlikely catastrophic one, but the realistic bad outcome I should be prepared for. Tell me: how bad is it really? Is it recoverable? And what would I need to have in place to recover from it?"

CATEGORY 4

LEADERSHIP DECISIONS

Decisions about people, relationships, and organizational dynamics.

16. Decide Whether to Promote or Let Go

"I'm facing a decision about [role]: whether to promote/invest further or move on. Here is what I observe: [describe performance and behaviors]. Here is what I'm uncertain about: [describe]. Give me the question I should ask in a direct conversation with this person that would give me the clearest signal about the right decision."

17. Navigate a Stakeholder Disagreement

"Here is a disagreement I'm navigating between [stakeholder A] and [stakeholder B] about [issue]. Each party's position is: [describe]. What is the underlying interest beneath each stated position? Where is there a potential zone of agreement they may not have seen? And what is the minimum viable outcome that both parties could live with?"

18. Decide on Organizational Structure

"I'm considering reorganizing [describe current structure] to [describe proposed structure]. Evaluate the proposal on: what it optimizes for, what it sacrifices, who is likely to resist it and why, and what would need to be true for it to work. Tell me the one thing I'm most likely underestimating about this change."

19. Set Team Priorities

"My team of [describe] has the following competing demands: [list]. Our most important outcome in the next [timeframe] is [describe]. Build a priority stack that clearly names what we're doing first, what we're doing second, and what we're explicitly not doing. Include one sentence of rationale for each that I can share with the team."

20. Decide How to Deliver Difficult News

"I need to communicate [difficult news] to [audience]. The news is: [describe]. Help me structure the communication so it: leads with the most important fact, explains the reasoning honestly, acknowledges the impact on the audience, and ends with what happens next. Give me the one thing I'm most tempted to soften that I should instead say directly."

CATEGORY 5

GROWTH DECISIONS

Decisions about how to allocate resources to grow faster or more efficiently.

21. Hire vs. Outsource

"I need [capability] for [purpose]. Evaluate three options: hiring someone internally, outsourcing to an agency or contractor, or using AI to partially or fully address the need. For each option, give me the realistic cost, the timeline to full capability, and the main risk."

22. Pricing Decision Framework

"I'm considering [pricing change: increase/restructure/add tier]. My current pricing is [describe]. Walk me through: the most likely customer response, the impact on new customer acquisition versus retention, the message it sends about where we're positioned, and the one unintended consequence I'm least likely to have considered."

23. Analyze Customer Feedback for Growth Signals

"Here is customer feedback I've collected: [paste]. Analyze it for growth signals, not just the satisfaction data, but what it reveals about: the customer segments most likely to expand, the use cases we're underdeveloped in, and the competitor we're most often replacing or being compared to. Give me the one growth hypothesis this data most supports."

24. Investment Decision Analysis

"I'm considering investing [describe resource] in [describe opportunity]. Evaluate the investment on: expected return and time to see it, key assumptions that must hold for the return to materialize, what the minimum viable version of this investment looks like, and at what point I should cut my losses if it's not working."

25. Enter or Exit a Market

"I'm deciding whether to [enter/exit] [market or segment]. Here is what I know about it: [describe]. Here is our current position: [describe]. Evaluate the decision on: the strength of our right to win, the opportunity cost of the resources required, and the reversibility of the decision. Tell me the decision I'll regret more in three years: entering too late, or exiting too early."

? WHAT THIS CHANGES

- 60% of executives now use AI to support their decisions.
- The ones getting the most from it aren't using AI to generate content about their decisions.
- They're using it to think more clearly before they make them.
- That's what these 25 prompts are for. Not writing. Thinking.

THE **AI** REPORT

THE NATURAL NEXT STEP

**YOU HAVE THE DECISION FRAMEWORKS.
NOW GET THE TOOLS TO RUN THEM AT SCALE.**



16 lessons



HubSpot AI playbooks



AI tools quick-start



3 custom GPTs



GET THE **AI LEADER
LAUNCH GUIDE **\$9/month****

